

Prototype Design · Version A and Version B

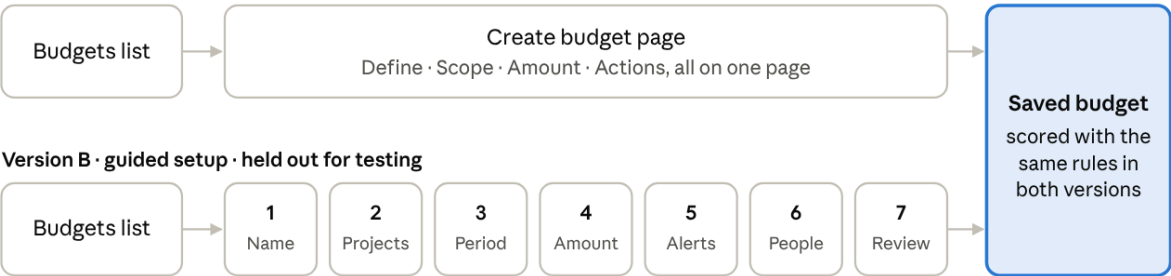
At a glance

Version A is the advanced form copied from Google Cloud. Version B is a simplified guided setup modeled on AWS's template workflow. Both create the same budget and are scored the same way.

	Version A · advanced form	Version B · guided setup
Modeled on	Google Cloud Budgets & alerts	AWS Budgets simplified template workflow, rebuilt with Google Cloud's settings and defaults
Shape	Four sections on one long create page	Seven screens, one question each
Hidden settings	None	Extra scope filters and advanced notification options, left at defaults
Role in the study	Calibration data for synthetic users	Held-out test of calibrated synthetic users
Expected errors	More, which gives calibration something to learn	Fewer, which is the design's hypothesis

Same budget, two paths to it

Version A · advanced form · used for calibration



Same task, same fake account, same starting defaults. Only the path to each setting changes.

A and B flows · 2 paths to one saved budget

The Design and Build Guide (v2) sets the rules. This document shows what each screen looks like and says. When they disagree, the guide wins.

Shared shell

Everything outside the create flow is the same page in both versions. Build it once and switch only the create flow by variant. The study viewport is 1440 by 900. Use Roboto and a neutral product name such as Cloud Console (prototype), with no Google logo.

Area	What it shows	Notes
Task bar	The task text from guide Part 3, word for word, with an I'm finished button on the right	Fixed above the console frame on every page, stubs included. Fixed height so screenshots line up across sessions.
Console frame	A top bar with the product name, the account Northstar Research and the signed-in user Alex Kim. A left menu with Overview, Reports, Budgets & alerts and Account management.	Reports opens the neutral placeholder page.
Billing overview	The start page. It shows the account name with its ID. Below that sit this month's cost so far and a small cost chart split by project.	All numbers come from the frozen fixture.
Budgets & alerts list	A table of budgets with Name, Scope, Amount and Alerts columns. A Create budget button sits above the table.	Starting contents follow the Part 13 decision in the guide.
Saved budget view	The saved values in the reference layout, with an Edit button	Edit reopens the variant's own create flow with saved values loaded. In B it opens the review screen.
Account management	A read-only table of billing account members. Alex Kim (you) is Billing Account Administrator. Jordan Lee is Billing Account User.	Matches the fixture exactly, since B lists these same names.
Notification channels stub	"Notification channels are outside this study." plus a back link	Reached from Manage notification channels in A.

Area	What it shows	Notes
Other links	"This page is not part of the study." plus a back link	Every visit is logged.

The create flow is the only part that changes. Pressing Create budget in the list opens the A form or the B guided setup depending on the session's variant.

Version A - the advanced form

A copies the Google Cloud create budget page. It is one long page with four numbered sections stacked on the left and a cost trend chart on the right. Each section has a Next button that opens the one below it. A section heading can be clicked at any time to reopen it. Finish and Cancel sit at the bottom of the page.

Section by section

Section	Controls	Starts at
1 Define	Budget name text field. Budget kind shown as Alerts only.	Name empty
2 Scope	Time range dropdown with Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly and Custom range. Folders & organizations picker. Projects multi-select listing Atlas and Beacon. Services picker. Labels picker. Savings checkboxes. Read-only for project users checkbox.	Monthly. Projects from the capture. All savings types checked. Read-only unchecked.
3 Amount	Budget type choice between Specified amount and Last month's spend. Target amount field in dollars.	Specified amount, field empty
4 Actions	Threshold table with Percent of budget, Amount and Trigger on columns. Trigger on is a dropdown with Actual and Forecasted. Add threshold button and a delete icon per row. Below it, Manage notifications.	Three rows at 50%, 90% and 100% of Actual

Manage notifications in section 4

- **Email alerts to billing admins and users.** Checked at start. No names are shown next to it, which is the gap B tries to close.
- **Email alerts to project owners.** Marked Preview. Appears only when Projects holds exactly one project. Unchecked at start.
- **Link Monitoring email notification channels to this budget.** Unchecked. Checking it reveals a project picker, and both projects list zero channels. The Manage notification channels link opens the stub.
- **Connect a Pub/Sub topic to this budget.** Unchecked. Checking it reveals a topic picker with no topics.

Cost trend chart

The chart follows the Scope filters, so choosing Atlas alone changes the bars. It shows fixture numbers only. Where it sits when the user reaches section 4 at 1440 by 900 is still to be confirmed in the capture.

What A does not have

No review page before saving and no names next to recipient options. There is also no one-question-at-a-time flow. These are exactly the things B adds, so A must not borrow any of them.

Version B · the guided setup

B asks one question per screen, in the style of the AWS simplified template workflow tailored for Google Cloud. AWS supplies only the one-question-per-screen pattern. Every setting and default comes from Google Cloud, and so does every product rule. Only the path through them changes. Every screen has the same layout. A progress bar at the top lists all seven screen names with the current one marked. Under it sit the question in large type and a one-line reason in grey. The controls come next, with Back and Continue at the bottom. Continue names the next screen.

Every screen starts at the reference default. Nothing is prefilled from the task answer, and no option is labeled recommended.

Screen	Question	Reason line	Controls	Starts at	Main button
1 Name	What should this budget be called?	A clear name helps you find it later.	Text field	Empty	Continue to projects
2 Projects	Which costs should this budget track?	Costs from projects you leave out will not count toward this budget.	All projects in Northstar Research, or Only specific projects	Reference default from the capture	Continue to period

Screen	Question	Reason line	Controls	Starts at	Main button
3 Period	How often should the budget start over?	Spending resets to \$0 at the start of each period.	Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly or Custom dates	Monthly	Continue to amount
4 Amount	How much should this budget allow each period?	Alerts are measured against this amount.	A fixed amount with a dollar field, or Match last period's spend	Fixed amount, field empty	Continue to alerts
5 Alerts	When should alert emails go out?	Each rule sends an email when spending reaches a share of the amount.	One sentence per rule	50%, 90% and 100% of money already spent	Continue to recipients
6 Recipients	Who should get alert emails?	These people get an email whenever an alert rule is reached.	One checkbox per group, with names listed under each	Billing account admins and users checked	Continue to review
7 Review	Here is your budget	Check each answer before you create the budget.	Summary lines with Edit links	Not applicable	Create budget

Screen 2 · Projects

Two radio options. Choosing Only specific projects reveals a checklist.

- Atlas · atlas-demo
- Beacon · beacon-demo

Each chosen project shows as a chip under the question, for example "Tracking · Atlas". The chip row stays visible as long as the user is on this screen. If Only specific projects is chosen with nothing checked, Continue shows "Choose at least one project".

Screen 5 · Alerts

Each rule is one editable sentence.

| Email when **money already spent** ▼ reaches **50 %** (\$500)

The bold parts are controls. The dropdown switches between money already spent and money expected by the end of the period. The dollar figure in brackets updates from the screen 4 amount. Each row has a remove icon, and an Add another rule link sits below the list. Removing every rule is allowed.

Screen 6 · Recipients

- ☒ **Billing account admins and users**
 - o Alex Kim (you) · Billing Account Administrator
 - o Jordan Lee · Billing Account User
- ☐ **Project owners**
 - o Sam Rivera · Atlas owner

The Project owners option appears only when screen 2 holds exactly one project. The name under it is that project's owner, so Priya Shah would appear for Beacon. When the option is hidden, one grey line says "Project owner emails are available when the budget covers one project." When there are no alert rules, both options are disabled and the screen says "Alert emails are off because there are no alert rules." When rules exist and nothing is checked, Continue shows "Choose at least one recipient".

Screen 7 · Review

One line per earlier screen, each with an Edit link on the right. Example with a filled-in budget:

Item	Your answer
Name	Atlas monthly
Tracks	Only Atlas
Starts over	Every month
Amount	\$1,000 each month
Alerts	Email when money already spent reaches 50% (\$500). Also at 80% (\$800).
Recipients	Project owners · Sam Rivera

Edit opens that screen, and its main button then reads Back to review. Create budget saves and opens the saved budget view. B offers no switch to the advanced form.

Wireframes

The two drawings show the same decision point in each version, choosing who gets the alert. They are layout sketches. Final spacing and styling follow the reference capture.

One screen from each version at the moment of choosing recipients

Version A · create page, section 4 open

Task bar · task text · I'm finished

Menu

1 Define

2 Scope

3 Amount

4 Actions

Threshold rules

50% · Actual

90% · Actual

100% · Actual

+ Add threshold

Manage notifications

☒ Billing admins and users

☐ Project owners · Preview

☐ Monitoring channels

☐ Pub/Sub topic

Finish

Cost trend

Everything sits on one page. Recipients are group names only.

Version B · screen 6 of 7

Task bar · task text · I'm finished

Menu

Recipients · step 6 of 7

Who should get alert emails?

These people get an email whenever an alert rule is reached.

☒ Billing account admins and users

Alex Kim (you) · Billing Account Administrator

Jordan Lee · Billing Account User

☐ Project owners

Sam Rivera · Atlas owner

Back

Continue to review

One question per screen. Real names sit under each choice.

wireframes · A section 4 beside B screen 6

In A the recipient choice is four checkboxes near the bottom of a long page, named by role group only. In B it is the whole screen, and each choice lists the real people it would email. It is one of the clearest places where the two paths differ.

States and edge cases

Both versions run on the same product rules, so each case below behaves the same way underneath. Only what the user sees differs.

Case	Version A	Version B	Logged as
Owner option checked, then a second project is added	The project owners checkbox disappears and clears	The Project owners option disappears and clears. The grey note appears.	Cleared value as its own event
Every alert rule removed	Email settings turn disabled	Screen 6 says alert emails are off, with both options disabled	Rule removals
Rules exist but no recipient is chosen	Reference error copy from the capture, shown on Finish	"Choose at least one recipient" on Continue	Validation event

Case	Version A	Version B	Logged as
Only specific projects with nothing checked	Reference error copy from the capture	"Choose at least one project" on Continue	Validation event
Amount empty or not a number	Reference error copy from the capture	"Enter an amount greater than \$0" on Continue	Validation event
Going back	Reopening a section keeps its values	Back keeps every earlier answer	Section or screen view
Edit from review	Not applicable	Opens that screen, then returns to review	Review edit
Leaving the flow through the menu	Follows the capture	Same rule as A	Navigation event
I'm finished pressed before saving	The attempt ends with no saved budget	Same	Completion declared
Saved budget reopened and changed	Scored by the rules in guide Part 7	Same	Save event

Every valid configuration can be saved, including ones that fail the task. An entire-account budget saves normally. So does a forecast rule. The evaluator judges task accuracy later and never shows it to the participant.